Muhammad Yasir Khan

Contact Information

Address: 4907 Wesley W. Posvar Hall, 230 South Bouquet Street, Pittsburgh, PA 15260
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Employment

Associate Professor
Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh — 2026 -

Assistant Professor
Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh — 2021 - 2026

Research Affiliations

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (JPAL), Center For Economic Research Pakistan (CERP), AALIMS, Center for Governance and Markets, IZA Network at LISER

Education

University of California, Berkeley - Haas School of Business
Ph.D in Business Administration — 2015 - 2021

Columbia University
Masters in Public Administration — 2008 - 2009

National University of Singapore
Masters in Public Policy — 2007 - 2009

Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS)
B.Sc. (honors) in Economics — 2003 - 2007

Publications

"Mission Motivation and Public Sector Performance: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan", *American Economic Review* (2025)

""Good Politicians": Experimental Evidence on Motivations for Political Candidacy and Government Performance", with Saad Gulzar, *The Review of Economic Studies* (2025)

"Personalities and Public Sector Performance: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan", with Arman Rezaee, Michael Callen, Ali Hasanain, and Saad Gulzar, *Economic Development and Cultural Change* (2025)

"Using Preference Parameter Estimates to Optimize Public Sector Wage Contracts: A Field Study in Pakistan", with James Andreoni, Michael Callen, Karrar Hussain and Charles Sprenger, *Journal of European Economic Association* (2023)

"No bulls: Experimental Evidence on the Impact of Veterinarian Ratings in Pakistan", with Arman Rezaee, and Ali Hasanain, *Journal of Development Economics* (2023)

"The Political Economy of Public Employee Absence: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan", with Michael Callen, Ali Hasanain, Saad Gulzar, and Arman Rezaee, *Journal of Public Economics* (2023)

"Data and Policy Decisions: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan", with Michael Callen, Saad Gulzar, Ali Hasanain, and Arman Rezaee, *Journal of Development Economics* (2020)

"Improving public health delivery in Punjab, Pakistan: issues and opportunities", with Michael Callen, Ali Hasanain, Saad Gulzar, Abdur Rehman Khan, and Zia Mehmood *The Lahore Journal of Economics* (2013)

Working Papers

"When Credit Lines Open Fault Lines: Economic and Political Effects of Bank Lending", with S.K. Ritadhi

"Men's Beliefs and Women's Ballots", with Saad Gulzar

"Extreme Heat and Public Services: Evidence from Vaccinations in Pakistan", with Karrar Hussain,

Jiawei Lyu, and Gabriel Tourek

"Digital Access to Justice: Evidence from Women's Virtual Police Stations in Pakistan", with Bakhtawar Ali, Amna Baig, Saad Gulzar, and Muhammad Ahsan Younus

Work in Progress

"Mental Health and Worker Performance: Evidence from the Public Sector", with Prashant Bhandari, Zain Chaudhry, Dietmar Fehr, and Karrar Hussain

"Extending State Capacity with Technology: Interactive Mobile Support to Improve Consistency and Accuracy for Community Health Workers ", with Erika Field, Nicola Singletary, Laura Stilwell, & Kate Vyborny

"Time Preferences and Dishonesty in the Public Sector", with Priyoma Mustafi

"Remote Delivery of Behavioral Therapy for Perinatal Depression and Anxiety through Digital Clinics in Low-Resource Settings: A Randomized Controlled Trial", with Zia Hydari

Monographs

"Barriers to Political Entry: Experimental Evidence from Pakistan", with Saad Gulzar, *mimeo*

"Learning in public schools", with Tahir Andrabi, Sohaib Khan and Farooq Naseer, *International Growth Centre*

"Norms, Beliefs, and Networks: Descriptive Findings on Women's Political Participation in Pakistan", with Saad Gulzar and Luke Sonnet

Fellowships and Grants

Reducing Conflict and Improving Performance in the Economy (£99,000), *PI*	2026
JPAL Crime and Violence Initiative (Exploratory Grant, $ 9,750), *PI*	2026
Pitt Business 2030 Research Grant ($ 12,000), *co-PI*	2025
Center for Governance and Markets ($14,000), *PI*	2024
International Growth Centre (£30,397), *PI*	2024
Pitt Momentum Funds, Priming Grant ($24,000), *PI*	2024
DFG, German Research Foundation Grant (Euros 330,000), *collaborator*	2023
International Growth Centre (£20,000), *co-PI*	2022
International Growth Centre (£44,000), *PI*	2021
IRLE Fellowship ($15,000), Sasakawa Fellowship ($50,000) & Oliver Williamson Fund ($4,000)	2020
CEGA Development Economics ($15,000) & Weiss Family Fund ($15,800), *PI*	2019
International Growth Centre (£20,000), *co-PI* & Institute for Business Innovation ($10,000),	2018
International Growth Centre (£15,272) & JPAL Governance Initiative ($94,796), *co-PI*	2018
International Growth Centre (£66,000), & JPAL Governance Initiative ($ 73,000), *co-PI*	2015
Agricultural Technology and Adoption Initiative ($ 50,000), *co-PI*	2014
International Growth Centre (£10,000), *co-PI*	2012
International Growth Centre (£50,000), *co-PI*	2011

Invited Talks

University of Wisconsin-Madison, USC Birnkrant Conference, TrEnCE	2026
Cornell University, University of Notre Dame, Georgetown University, UCLA Luskin, Oxford University, UC Irvine, UC San Diego	2025
UIUC, University of Michigan, Public Administration Reform Global Forum World Bank	2024
University of Virginia	2023
Georgetown University, Development Rookiefest at Northwestern University	2022
University of Pittsburgh, University of California Santa Cruz, University of Oxford, Duke University, Essex, Universidad del Rosario, POLECONUK	2021

Conferences

Midwest International Economic Development Conference	2026
Society for Institutional and Organizational Economics	2024

BREAD-MIT, Call to Service at Stanford, AALIMS-Stanford, PacDev (U of Washington), NEUDC, Institutions and Innovations Conference 2023

KDI-DIME, CSAE Conference on Economic Development in Africa, MWIEDC, SIOE, ECBE, NEUDC, Field Days, PacDev (UC Berkeley), Institutions and Innovations Conference 2021

Teaching

University of Pittsburgh: Graduate Development Economics (Econ 3440), Graduate Labor Economics (Econ 3410), Poverty and International Development (Econ 1710), Labor and Development Seminar (Econ 1710), Introduction to Development Economics (Econ 0530)

UC Berkeley (as Graduate Student Instructor): Economics for Business Decisions (Microeconomics), Ethics and Responsible Leadership

Advising and Service

Graduate Students: Priyoma Mustafi, Hanrui Zeng, Bruno Komel, Prashant Bhandari, Yu Qui, Humoyun Abdumavlon, Josue Djossou, Kamran Hakiman

Committee: Graduate Admissions Committee, Second Year Paper Award Committee (2022)

Mentorship: Association for Mentoring & Inclusion in Economics (AMIE) (2023-2025)

Invited Referee

Review of Economic Studies, Economic Journal, American Economic Journal: Applied, American Economic Review: Insights,Econometrica, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of European Economic Association, Journal of Development Economics, Management Science, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Journal of Politics, World Bank Economic Review, Quarterly Journal of Political Science, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Comparative Economics, Economica, National Science Foundation

Awards

"Vice Chancellor's Alumni Achievement Award" by Lahore University of Management Sciences 2025

"50 Influential Researchers Whose Work Could Help Shape 21st Century Politicians" by Apolitical Foundation Germany 2023

Work Experience

International Growth Centre (IGC)
Pakistan Country Economist 2011 - 2015

Aga Khan Foundation
Research Officer 2010 - 2011

Other

Languages: English (fluent), Pashto (native), Urdu (fluent)
Nationality: Pakistani

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